Cole Preston

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Research Interests

East Asian Political Economy, International Trade, Industrial Policy

Education

University of California, Santa Cruz — Santa Cruz, CA
Bachelor of Arts in Mathematics and Economics, Minor in East Asian Studies — *Sept. 2024 – Expected Fall 2027*

Keio University — Tokyo, Japan
UCEAP Keio International Program — *Sept. 2026 – Aug. 2027*

- Focus: Japanese Foreign Policy, Competition Policy, Public Policy, China–Japan Relations, Money and Banking, and Japanese Language
- Honors: UCEAP Duttenhaver Scholarship; UCEAP Global Scholarship

De Anza College — Cupertino, CA
A.A.-T Economics for Transfer | Magna Cum Laude — *Sept. 2022 – June 2024*

Leadership & Experience

UCSC Investment Banking Academy — Santa Cruz, CA
Advisor; formerly Co-President and Head of Equity Research — *Mar. 2025 – Present*

- As Co-President (Nov. 2025 – Jun. 2026), led club operations, setting weekly agendas and programming on finance, valuation, and markets; advising the executive team remotely while abroad since Jun. 2026
- As Head of Equity Research (Mar. 2025 – Nov. 2025), organized workshops on financial statement analysis, valuation modeling, and investment thesis development

UCSC Investment Fund — Santa Cruz, CA
TMT Sector Head — *Oct. 2025 – Jun. 2026*

- Led the TMT sector group, delivering a 112% gain across covered positions, the fund's top-performing sector
- Directed weekly research on valuation drivers, competitive positioning, and the macroeconomic, regulatory, and geopolitical risks behind sector recommendations

The Riekes Center for Human Enhancement — Menlo Park, CA
Coach and Instructor — *Aug. 2018 – Aug. 2026*

- Coached students through individualized strength, conditioning, and mobility programs, and led group classes and daily facility operations

Skills

Technical: Python, R, Econometrics, Regression Analysis, Data Analysis
Languages: English (Native); Japanese (Elementary)
Finance: Financial Statement Analysis, DCF and Comparables Valuation, Equity Research